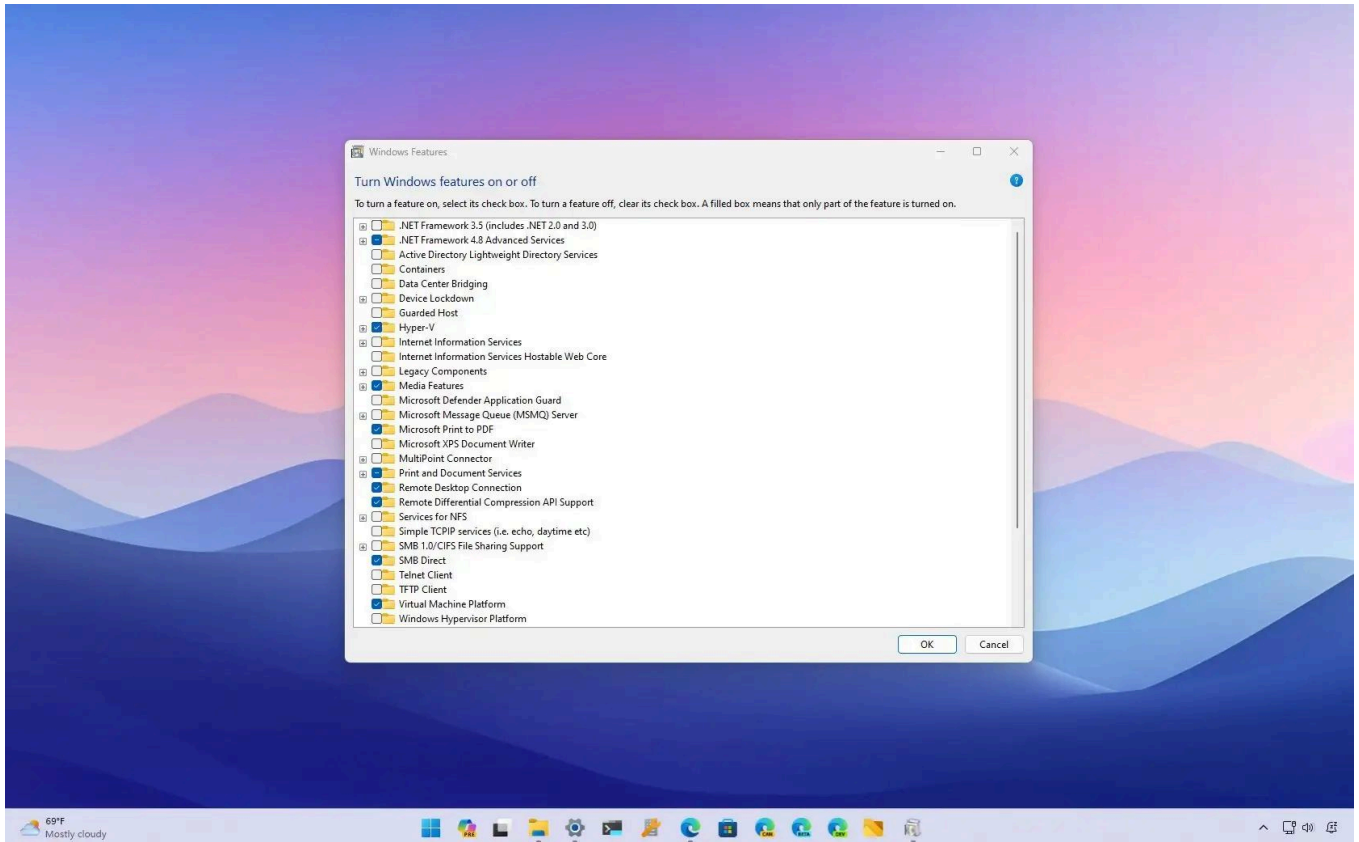


What's the difference between Hyper-V, Virtual Machine Platform, Windows Hypervisor Platform

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Windows 11 virtualization features

“**Hyper-V**” is a hypervisor that allows you to create virtual machines. The “**Virtual Machine Platform**” is typically used for WSL, while the “**Windows Hypervisor Platform**” is used by other virtualization platforms to connect to Hyper-V.

When you need to enable virtualization on [Windows 11](#) (or 10), you will find multiple options on the “Windows Features” page, including “Hyper-V,” “Virtual Machine Platform,” and “Windows Hypervisor Platform,” which can make the process confusing.

Hyper-V vs. Virtual Machine Platform vs. Windows Hypervisor Platform

If you need help understanding these features, you should know that each component is completely different.

- **Hyper-V:** This component adds the management tools and platform to [create and run virtual machines](#) on Windows 11.
- **Windows Hypervisor Platform:** Enables the [user-mode API components](#) to allow third-party virtualization stacks and applications (Docker, VirtualBox, and QEMU) to connect and interact with Hyper-V.

- **Virtual Machine Platform:** This component enables virtualization support to run virtual machines, and you must turn on this feature to use the [Windows Subsystem for Linux \(WSL\)](#). In addition, the component can also help to create MSIX app packages for an MSI or App-V.

In other words, if you want to create virtual machines on Windows 11, you want to enable the **Hyper-V** option, and if you plan to set up WSL on your computer, you want to install the **Virtual Machine Platform**.

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Update November 17, 2023: This content has been updated to ensure clarity.